THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE • NURSERY – CLASS XII • JAIPUR

Road No. 5, VKIA, Jaipur — 9887258679

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET A

Chapters 5–8: **New Beginnings: Cities and States, The Rise of Empires, The Age of Reorganisation, The Gupta Era: An Age of Tireless Creativity** | Class 7 Social Science | Maximum Marks: 50

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 12 × 1 = 12

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(c)** Harappan (Indus–Sarasvatī) civilisation	2nd millennium BCE decline
2	**(d)** 1st millennium BCE in the Ganga plains	new cities
3	**(a)** rājā	clan territory
4	**(a)** major trade routes	connected regions
5	**(b)** Textiles and spices	ancient evidence
6	**(b)** Ajātaśhatru	same period
7	**(a)** Kaṇṇagi and Kovalan	tale of the anklet
8	**(d)** Cheras, Cholas, Pāṇḍyas	Sangam age
9	**(a)** Vidisha	praises Vāsudeva
10	**(a)** spins on its axis	explains day and night
11	**(a)** the Mediterranean, Southeast Asia and China	Indian Ocean network
12	**(c)** Vākāṭaka dynasty	matrimonial alliance

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 5 × 2 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
13	Disappearance of planning, administration and trade led to rural life (2).	2
14	Samrāj and rājādhirāja (2).	2
15	Fertile land, iron and rivers for trade (2).	2
16	Chedi king of Kalinga, a Jain follower (2).	2
17	To announce their achievements to people (2).	2

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 6 × 3 = 18

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
18	Monarchies hereditary kings (1.5); gaṇas assembly chose rulers (1.5).	1½+1½
19	Army (1); administration and laws (1); trade and communication networks (1).	1+1+1
20	Poems of love and heroism (1.5); source for society and culture (1.5).	1½+1½
21	Āryabhaṭīya (1); Earth's rotation (1); year length, eclipses (1).	1+1+1
22	After Kuṣhāṇa decline (1); regional rulers near UP (1); empire under Chandragupta I and II (1).	1+1+1
	OR: People prosperous and happy (1.5); charity houses, but harsh treatment of chaṇḍālas (1.5).	1½+1½
23	Brahmins: knowledge and rituals (1); Kshatriyas: defence (1); Vaishyas, Shudras: trade, service (1).	1+1+1
	OR: People changed occupations in need (1.5); texts and inscriptions show this (1.5).	1½+1½

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
24	(i) Alexander (2). (ii) Defeated; reinstated (2). (iii) Contacts, satraps (1).	2+2+1
	OR: (i) Defence (1). (ii) Silk and spices (1). (iii) Emperor (1). (iv) Income and taxes (2).	1+1+1+2
25	(i) Provinces, land grants (2). (ii) Land tax, fines (2). (iii) Army, temples, scholars (1).	2+2+1
	OR: (i) Culture and science (2). (ii) Chandragupta I, Samudragupta, Chandragupta II (1). (iii) Conquest, tribute, alliances (2).	2+1+2

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

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ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET B

Chapters 5–8: **New Beginnings: Cities and States, The Rise of Empires, The Age of Reorganisation, The Gupta Era: An Age of Tireless Creativity** | Class 7 Social Science | Maximum Marks: 50

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 12 × 1 = 12

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(c)** Prayagraj	Vatsa capital
2	**(a)** Vedic texts	four categories
3	**(a)** taxes or revenue	to maintain army and order
4	**(a)** supreme power	ruling many territories
5	**(b)** Ajātaśhatru	6th–5th century BCE
6	**(c)** Aṣhṭādhyāyī (Sanskrit grammar)	3,996 sūtras
7	**(c)** Madurai	pearls and naval power
8	**(d)** Kaṇiṣhka	headless statue
9	**(c)** south India	Tamil poetry
10	**(c)** land tax	plus fines, trade taxes
11	**(d)** regent	after her husband died
12	**(a)** Bṛihat Saṃhitā	weather, town planning, farming

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 5 × 2 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
13	Assemblies of the clan that advised the king (2).	2
14	Sanskrit grammarian who wrote the Aṣhṭādhyāyī (2).	2
15	Railings of Bharhut Stūpa (1); Buddhist reliefs (1).	1+1
16	To honour mothers who were powerful, e.g. Gautamī Balaśhrī (2).	2
17	Over 1,600 years old and rust-free (2).	2

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 6 × 3 = 18

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
18	Better ploughs (1); stronger weapons (1); trade and cities grew (1).	1+1+1
19	Swāmi, amātya, janapada (1); durga, koṣha (1); daṇḍa, mitra (1).	1+1+1
20	Kovalan wrongly executed (1.5); Kaṇṇagi proves innocence and burns Madurai (1.5).	1½+1½
21	Married Vākāṭaka prince (1); regent after his death (1); built Viṣhṇu temples (1).	1+1+1
22	Clans settled with a rājā (1); trade networks grew (1); small states merged (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Hereditary restrictions over time (1.5); inequality and discrimination (1.5).	1½+1½
23	Fierce war in Odisha (1.5); he adopted peace and Buddhism (1.5).	1½+1½
	OR: King's happiness lies in the happiness of subjects (1.5); give people's interests first place (1.5).	1½+1½

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
24	(i) Gandhāra; Anga (1). (ii) Magadha, Kosala, Vatsa, Avanti (1). (iii) Fertile land, iron (1). (iv) Ujjayinī—Ujjain (2).	1+1+1+2
	OR: (i) Clan territories merged (2). (ii) Assemblies and rājā (2). (iii) Fortified (1).	2+2+1
25	(i) Silappadikāram (1). (ii) Kovalan (1). (iii) King dies and Madurai burns (1). (iv) Justice and dharma (2).	1+1+1+2
	OR: (i) Empire split and invasions (2). (ii) Śhungas, Sātavāhanas, Cholas, Kuṣhāṇas, Chedis (2). (iii) Marriage alliances and war (1).	2+2+1

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

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ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET C

Chapters 5–8: **New Beginnings: Cities and States, The Rise of Empires, The Age of Reorganisation, The Gupta Era: An Age of Tireless Creativity** | Class 7 Social Science | Maximum Marks: 50

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 12 × 1 = 12

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(a)** Bhubaneswar	Odisha
2	**(c)** iron metallurgy	better tools and weapons
3	**(c)** Rājagṛiha	later Pataliputra
4	**(c)** Kalinga	Odisha
5	**(b)** saptānga	swāmi, amātya, janapada, durga, koṣha, daṇḍa, mitra
6	**(c)** tributary (vassal)	accepts overlordship
7	**(d)** 3rd century CE	weak control
8	**(b)** red sandstone	Indian style
9	**(b)** Puṣhyamitra Śhunga	his commander-in-chief
10	**(a)** Śhiva	temple builders
11	**(c)** Chandragupta II	dedicated to Viṣhṇu
12	**(a)** A Record of Buddhistic Kingdoms	travelogue

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 5 × 2 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
13	New phase of city growth in the 1st millennium BCE in the Ganga plains (2).	2
14	A collection of kingdoms ruled by a powerful ruler who gets tribute (2).	2
15	Founder of the Śhunga dynasty who killed the last Maurya king (2).	2
16	Art, literature, science flourished (2).	2
17	Daughter of Chandragupta II who ruled the Vākāṭaka kingdom as regent (2).	2

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 6 × 3 = 18

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
18	Discussed clan matters (1); advised rājā (1); could remove incompetent ruler (1).	1+1+1
19	Alexander defeated Porus (1.5); soldiers refused to go on and he retreated (1.5).	1½+1½
20	Puṣhyamitra's kingdom (1.5); Vedic revival and Bharhut art (1.5).	1½+1½
21	Conquests and tribute (1.5); patron of art and trade (1.5).	1½+1½
22	Ambition and fame (1); resources (1); wealth (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Fertile land and forests (1); iron ploughs and weapons (1); Ganga and Son rivers (1).	1+1+1
23	Rock-cut for Jain monks (1.5); intricate panels and rooms (1.5).	1½+1½
	OR: Deccan empire (1); maritime trade with Rome (1); patronage of religions (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
24	(i) Gymnosophists (1). (ii) Life (1). (iii) Wisdom (1). (iv) Spared them (2).	1+1+1+2
	OR: (i) Fertile land and resources (1). (ii) Farming and war (1). (iii) Trade (1). (iv) Ajātaśhatru, Mahāpadma Nanda (2).	1+1+1+2
25	(i) Indian Ocean trade (2). (ii) Textiles, spices, Mediterranean (2). (iii) Strategic stop (1).	2+2+1
	OR: (i) Warrior-patron (2). (ii) By Harisena (2). (iii) Tributaries (1).	2+2+1

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.